

Topic: Articles of Faith

Sub Topic: Belief in Oneness of Allah

Q (a) Outline the Muslim teaching about the belief in the oneness of God (tawhid).

[10]

Structure of Answer

Para 1:

- Literal Meaning of Tawheed.
- General Introduction as the fundamental teaching of Islam.

Para 2:

- 3 Aspects of Oneness (Tawheed)
 1. Oneness of the Lordship of God (Tawheed-e-Rububiyat)
 2. Oneness in worship of God (Tawheed-e-Uloohiyat)
 3. Oneness of the names and qualities of God (Tawheed-e-Asmaa Wa-Sifaat)

Para 3:

- Evidences of Tawheed (Oneness)
- Shirk (Polytheism)

Answer

- Literal meaning of Tawheed is 'Unification' It is declaration that Allah is one in his person, dominion and attributes.
- Belief in Oneness of Allah is not only the fundamental teaching of Islam but it has always been the base of every religion from Adam till Jesus. All the previous books and scriptures lay too much emphasis on belief in Oneness of Allah. Quran being final book of Allah Highlights the importance of believing in Oneness of Allah and presents evidences for it.
 - ❖ Ref: "So know, that there is no deity except Allah..." [47:19]
- There are 3 aspects of Oneness that Muslims are supposed to believe in.
- Oneness of the Lordship of God (Tawheed-e-Rububiyat) is believing in Allah as the only The Originator, The Sustainer, The Cherisher, The All Mighty and The Provider. This negates the possibility of any partner in Allah's lordship:
 - ❖ Ref: "praise is to Allah, Lord of the worlds" [01:02]Allah is the only one who provides us with sustainable environment and other bounties:
 - ❖ Ref: And the earth - We have spread it and cast therein firmly set mountains and caused to grow therein [something] of every well-balanced thing" [15:19]Even Pagans of Makkah used to believe in this aspect of Oneness:
 - ❖ Ref: "If you asked them, "Who created the heavens and earth and subjected the sun and the moon?" they would surely say, 'Allah' Then how are they deluded?" [29:61]
- Oneness in worship of God (Tawheed-e-Uloohiyat) is believing in Allah as only one liable to be worshiped. This believe requires believers to understand that all types of worship are only due to Allah. Being our Originator, Cherisher and Sustainer He is the only power who is worthy to be worshiped.

❖ Ref: "It is You we worship and You we ask for help" [01:05] ❖ Ref: "And I did not create the jinn and mankind except to worship Me." [51:56] ▪ Oneness of the names and qualities of God (Tawheed-e-Asmaa Wa-Sifaat) is believing that Allah is simply exclusive in his qualities and attributes. Allah is only 'Al-Muh'Yi' (Giver of Life) 'Al-Mumeet' (Giver of Death) 'Al-Khaliq' (the Creator) 'Al-Baseer' (All-Seeing) etc. ❖ Ref: "He is Allah, other than whom there is no deity, the Sovereign, the Pure, the Perfection, the Bestower of Faith, the Overseer, the Exalted in Might, the Compeller, the Superior..." [59:23]
Allah does not resemble with any of his creation in person, power, dominion or attributes: ❖ Ref: ""There Is Nothing Like unto Him." [42:11]
▪ Allah (SWT) never wants his creation to believe in him blindly. Actually, He motivates us to ponder over his signs of perfect creation and come to a logical conclusion about Oneness of Allah. ❖ Ref: "...how can He have a son when He has no consort..." [06:101] ❖ Ref: "Had there been within the heavens and earth gods besides Allah, they both would have been ruined..." [21:22] ▪ Shirk (Polytheism) means considering partners with Allah in his person, powers, dominion, qualities or attributes. Though, Allah (SWT) loves his creation equal to seventy mothers but Shirk is a sin that ignites Allah's wrath. ❖ Ref: "Verily! Allah will not pardon those who associate a partner with Him..." [04:116] ❖ Ref: "Allah has said: "Do not establish two Gods: He is the only One Allah, worth worshipping: then fear Me" [16:51]

(b) Why is associating partners with God (shirk) regarded as a great sin? [4] [J/2013]

Points to be covered in Answer

- Because belief in one God is the fundamental teaching of Islam and all other previous religions. Associating partners with Allah (SWT) is attacking the base.
- Shirk is believing that the source of power, harm and blessings comes from others besides Allah.
- This would lead to destruction of all pillars of Islam and will affect the life in this world and hereafter.